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Interview: Amkette's transformation to a lifestyle tech brand

Amkette gives us a glimpse of how the brand has evolved and shares its future plans on developing unique products for Indian consumers.

Soham Raninga

sobam.raninga@tbinkdigit.com

We interview Mr. Rajiv Bapna, Founder and Director, Amkette. Mr. Bapna takes us through the evolution of Amkette from a brand famous for floppy disk to a brand now focused on pioneering acoustics and offering unique lifestyle products.

Q Amkette has transformed itself from being an IT peripherals company to a lifestyle brand, focusing on A/V entertainment. Why this shift and how has the journey been so far?

Amkette began its journey as a storage technology pioneer over 25 years ago and over the years transformed itself to meet the challenges of times yet keeping its core strengths alive. Since the beginning, Amkette had focused on R & D and innovations based on consumer insights. Even today, they remain the core DNA of Amkette. No wonder, all Amkette products are defined by distinctive design, innovative technology, affordable pricing and satisfying customer experience.

Today Amkette specializes in 4 technology areas; wireless, audio, multimedia and storage. A year ago, we introduced a path breaking multimedia product, named EVO TV. We have extended our expertise in multimedia to digital audio and are introducing a range of audio products for the current mobile-generation. Some of the exceptionally successful products have been Amkette Metal Speakers and Free Spirit Headphones. Our recent introduction



Rajiv Bapna,
Founder and Director, Amkette

has been a tangle-free earphones with metallic sound chamber to create superior bass.

We are enjoying what we do and so far journey has been encouraging.

Q The EVO TV is probably the most popular product in your portfolio, are you planning to expand the line-up and offer more options?

EVO TV was one of the most well-received products from Amkette in the market. We are planning to expand the product line as we are planning to come out with two new variants of the product which are more advanced and better suited for the changing needs of our audience. Some special app products are also in the pipeline the EVO TV.

Q Does Amkette have an R&D center in India? If yes, where is it and what kind of work does it focus on?

Yes Amkette has its R&D centres in India. Amkette's focussed R&D opera-

tions happen at two places: Delhi and Bangalore. The design and development of the products happens in Delhi whereas the software is developed in Bangalore.

Q What is Amkette doing differently compared to other competing brands to specifically cater to Indian audience? What is its USP?

All Amkette products are designed and developed after extensive consumer feedback. Therefore, each product from Amkette has a unique story for consumers. This, coupled with our core promise of cutting-edge technology, contemporary product design and affordable pricing makes Amkette a unique brand. This is particularly so in India, where consumers seek high quality products at a reasonable prices. As an example, Amkette Atom Earphones are very reasonably priced headphones which offer not only tangle free wires, but also a superior Metallic Sound Chamber.

Q What future trends do you see in the field of technology, particularly with respect to the market that Amkette is catering to?

Technology is moving at a fast pace. We pride ourselves in moving with technology and always work on a 12 months product roadmap. At this moment, we are particularly excited with portable audio and multimedia technologies on one hand and convergence of screens through wireless technology on the other. In both areas, we have strong technological base. Please stay tuned with many exciting products from Amkette in next 6 to 12 months. **Q**